



Microsoft's streaming device

Like Google's Chromecast, Microsoft is planning its own streaming device for Windows users
<http://dgit.in/MsftStreamer>



Handwashing tracker for hospitals

Biovigil wants doctors and nurses to keep their hands infection free by tracking how often they scrub with colour coding <http://dgit.in/Biovigil>

Geek life

You *may* be over-reacting

At the end of the day, the chances that we are all over-reacting to the whole digital addiction are very much plausible. This doesn't deny the fact that all the info that's available out there isn't taking a toll on our abilities to function properly say, at a work-place. But chances are, you can very easily get some work done if you just tried a little harder. Having experienced this before, such things are easier said than done. So, here's how you can use the power of the internet to keep you off the internet

There are apps for your smartphone as well as programs for your PC that can ban you from accessing the internet for periods of time. 'Digital Detox' is an app for the Android OS that essentially bricks your phone for periods of time. There's not way of disabling the app and your only choice is to wait it out.

'Pause' is an app available on iOS does just that. Available free on iOS, with an Android version somewhere in the plumbing, does the same thing, while Freedom, available for Android as well as your desktop (for a small fee) blocks your device/PC from connecting to the internet for up to eight hours at a time. The Android version also has an interesting feature called 1995 cellphone mode, which allows you to only make and receive calls.

A less extreme program for your PC is Cold Turkey. Instead of cutting you off completely as the name might suggest, Cold Turkey blocks certain blacklisted items that can range from programs to specific websites. Although it's available free of cost, you can donate a sum of your choosing and anywhere between 0 to a 100 percent can be donated to the Against Malaria Foundation.

For the writers constantly distracted by virtually everything their laptop or desk top has to offer, two programs help them through the day on Mac and on Windows. WriteRoom on the Mac and Dark Room on Windows block out virtually any other function that your computers have to offer and turn your machines in to fancy type-writers with digital screens. While neither of these programs actually disable any features, what they do provide are features akin to the blinders on a horse. Both these programs offer a full screen, distraction



You got this!

free environment where a writer is free to explore his thoughts without disruptions or distractions.

What to expect when you're not texting?

First of all, you realise that the ground is a lot farther away that you thought because you've been hunched over your phone all this time. But jokes aside, one of the first things you notice is that you've become a lot more observant of your surroundings. You also end up becoming a better listener and your girlfriend/spouse is going to be less of a grouse.

According to thedigitaldetox.org, you start feeling more refreshed as your sleep cycles become better, your breathing slows down and you're less stressed and most importantly, your disconnect from the internet makes you more connected with the world around you.

You end up becoming more mindful of yourself and the things around, become more efficient with work, more creative and procrastinate less.

Coming back to digital life

When your digital detox session comes to a close, depending on how long you were away and how many people you are in regular contact with, you're probably

going to have a huge list of notifications, messages and mails waiting for you.

Step one here is to not panic. Step two is to use your new found skills of patience and serenity to prioritise. Step three is to mark all your social media notifications as read and carry on with your life because you consume social media and that door should not swing the other way.

But do you really need a detox?

While is surely is a necessity if you're struggling to cope with the overload of information you are facing daily or you literally spend all day clicking through pictures of cats, to a large extent, the number of people diving in to the detox bandwagon are probably doing it because it's the latest fad. If you feel you spend way too much time on the internet, it would make sense to figure out what you do with your time online. Programs like Rescue Time do just that and tracks you activity for anywhere between a day and a year and lets you know how you spend your time. If you spend your time wisely by acquiring new skills or polishing existing ones and expanding your horizons, then godspeed. In our opinion, you sometimes need to take a step away to truly appreciate what you have in front of you. 